
With designer Tarun Tahiliani, ABFRL established a new company in February of last year and launched a contemporary men's ethnic wear brand called Tasva, with the goal of selling ₹500-crore worth of men's ethnic clothes and accessories in five years

Tarun Tahiliani
CREATIVE DIRECTOR, INDIVINITY CLOTHING PVT. LTD

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addresses the entire gamut of ethnic wear segments including value, premium and luxury, acquired a 51 per cent stake in designer brand Sabyasachi in January last year. The aim is to make Sabyasachi a global luxury lifestyle brand that includes everything from clothes and perfume to cosmetics and home furnishings. Currently, the brand straddles categories such as apparel, accessories and jewellery, and has a strong franchise in India, the US, the UK and the Middle-East. It recently concluded a one-month exhibition and sale of a special jewellery collection at Bergdorf Goodman in New York. It has previously tied up with global brands such as Christian Louboutin and Thomas Goode.

Sahni says that Indian designers will benefit greatly with the tie-ups and, going forward, their companies' valuations will go up manifold. "No one has sold off their business 100 per cent. Everyone has sold 33-51 per cent. The remaining part is going to be hugely valuable in 7-10 years."

According to him, if a brand has sold 51 per cent stake for ₹100 crore today, 10 years down the line the balance 49 per cent could be worth ₹2,000 crore, if all the plans of the corporate and the designer come true. He believes that at some point the corporates will acquire the design companies fully, but the time period may vary from 10-20 years. "By the end of that period, there is an option for either party to acquire fully or sell fully," he says. "While these are brands started by designers, eventually brands don't need individual designers. The brand is the name itself," he adds.

As corporates continue to invest in design houses and create bridge-to luxury and ready-to-wear lines, more and more Indians will be seen dressed in designer wear. **BT**

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